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COMPLAINT & GRIEVANCE HANDLING

in the Department of Posts

For LDCE – Inspector Posts (IP) & PS Group 'B' Examinations

Comprehensive, Exam-Oriented & Fully Updated Study Notes

Updated with law & orders in force as on 13 August 2026

Incorporates the DARPG 21-day Guidelines (2024), CVC Vigilance Manual 2021, the new SHe-Box portal (2024) and the NCSC/NCST framework

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How to Use These Notes

These notes cover the topic “Complaint & Grievance Handling” as it appears in the LDCE syllabus for Inspector Posts (IP) and Postal Service Group ‘B’. The subject sits at the meeting point of three regimes — the citizen-facing public-grievance machinery (DARPG / CPGRAMS and the India Post CRM), the vigilance and integrity machinery (CVC), and the service-matter and workplace-protection machinery (DoPT, MWCD and the Constitutional Commissions). The notes explain each stream in plain language, then give you the exact orders and dates you need to quote in the examination.

Legend of coloured boxes

Concept / Framework

Explains the “big picture” — how a mechanism is structured or where a body sits in the chain.

✓ Current Position (Verified)

The latest, in-force rule with its governing order and date — this is what you write in the exam.

⚠ Currency Alert / Correction

A point where the older study material (and the earlier version of these notes) was outdated or wrongly cited — read these carefully; examiners love the recent changes.

Exam Focus

The precise fact, expansion or figure most likely to be asked as an objective question.

What’s New — Currency Snapshot (2024–2026)

Grievance handling has changed materially since the older circulating notes were written. Memorise these five updates first — they are the most examinable and the most commonly got wrong:

#	Area	Old (outdated) position	Current position — what to write now
1	CPGRAMS timeline	30 days (2022 guidelines)	Reduced to 21 days by DARPG Comprehensive Guidelines dated 23.08.2024.
2	Vigilance / complaint handling	2016 CVC circular only	Consolidated in CVC Vigilance Manual 2021 + CVC Circular 25/12/21 dated 24.12.2021.

#	Area	Old (outdated) position	Current position — what to write now
3	POSH committee name	Internal Complaints Committee (ICC)	Renamed Internal Committee (IC) by the Repealing & Amending Act, 2016 (w.e.f. 09.05.2016).
4	SHe-Box portal	2017 portal (routed to MWCD)	New SHe-Box relaunched 29.08.2024 at shebox.wcd.gov.in; routes directly to the chosen IC/LC.
5	SC/ST grievance body	Commissioner for SC/ST	Now NCSC (Art. 338) & NCST (Art. 338A) — two Commissions since 2004; NCSC runs an e-GMP portal.

PART 1 — FOUNDATIONS

I. Introduction

Meaning of “Complaint” and “Grievance”

- **Complaint:** an expression of dissatisfaction made to an organisation about its products, services, or the complaint-handling process itself, where a response or resolution is expected. In the administrative sense it also covers an allegation of misconduct, corruption or harassment against a public servant.
- **Grievance:** a claim by a citizen or an employee that he/she has suffered an injustice, unfair treatment, or denial of a rightful service or benefit. It is broader than a complaint and often points to a systemic or service-delivery failure rather than a single lapse.

Complaint vs Grievance — the practical test

In day-to-day CPGRAMS/CRM work the words are used interchangeably. The useful distinction is: a *grievance* is about service delivery (delay, non-payment, denial), handled **administratively**; an *allegation of misconduct/corruption* is handled through the **vigilance** route. A single incident can start as one and convert into the other.

Why grievance redressal matters in public administration

- **Accountability & transparency** — keeps public officials answerable to the citizens they serve.
- **Feedback mechanism** — recurring grievances reveal bottlenecks and drive policy and process improvement (now formalised as “root cause analysis” under the 2024 guidelines).
- **Citizen-centric governance** — operationalises the “Maximum Governance, Minimum Government” and “Ease of Living” agenda by making service delivery responsive and empathetic.

Role of the Department of Posts

The Department of Posts (DoP) is one of the oldest and most widely distributed public-service networks in the world, with a daily interface with crores of citizens across mail, banking (POSB/IPPB), insurance (PLI/RPLI) and retail services. A robust, time-bound grievance mechanism is therefore essential. DoP must resolve service deficiencies (delay or loss of articles, abstraction of contents, delayed Money Orders, pending COD remittances) and, separately, handle internal complaints (vigilance, sexual harassment, SC/ST service grievances) strictly in accordance with CVC, MWCD and DoPT instructions.

II. The Grievance-Redressal Architecture (Big Picture)

Before the individual mechanisms, fix the overall chain in your mind. A citizen's postal grievance travels through three tiers, and there is a separate internal track for integrity and service matters.

The three public-facing tiers (escalation chain)

Tier 1 — Department (internal): India Post CRM portal (crm.indiapost.gov.in), the National Call Centre (1800-266-6868), counters, the PostInfo app and social media. First and fastest point of resolution.

Tier 2 — Government of India: CPGRAMS (pgportal.gov.in), administered by DARPG. If a citizen is not satisfied with the Department, or files directly on CPGRAMS, the grievance is auto-routed to the DoP nodal officer.

Tier 3 — Apex appeal: Directorate of Public Grievances (DPG), Cabinet Secretariat (dpg.gov.in), for a select list of organisations (which includes the Department of Posts), where redress remains unsatisfactory after a reasonable time.

✓ Current Position (Verified)

India Post's own grievance page directs an unsatisfied citizen to escalate to the **DPG, Cabinet Secretariat (dpg.gov.in)**. The CRM portal remains live at crm.indiapost.gov.in with toll-free **1800-266-6868** (confirmed on India Post's official channels, 2026).

The main portals at a glance

Portal / channel	Owner	Purpose
CRM (crm.indiapost.gov.in)	Department of Posts	Internal complaint-redressal system for all postal services.
CPGRAMS (pgportal.gov.in)	DARPG	Single-window Government-of-India grievance portal (also on UMANG / mobile app / CSCs).
DPG (dpg.gov.in)	Cabinet Secretariat	Apex appellate grievance body for select organisations, including DoP.

Portal / channel	Owner	Purpose
SHe-Box (shebox.wcd.gov.in)	MWCD	Workplace sexual-harassment complaints — routed to the chosen IC/LC.
NCSC e-GMP (ncscmis.nic.in)	NCSC	Grievances of Scheduled Caste citizens/employees to the Commission.

III. Classification of Complaints

Complaints in the Department are grouped by their nature and by the authority competent to deal with them:

- Public grievances (service deficiencies)** — core postal operations: delay in delivery, loss of articles, abstraction of contents, non-payment or delay of Money Orders, and pending COD amounts.
- Vigilance complaints** — allegations of corruption, malpractice, misappropriation of public funds, or abuse of official position; handled strictly under CVC guidelines.
- Anonymous & pseudonymous complaints** — those without a genuine, verifiable name/address; a special no-action rule applies (Chapter X).
- Sexual-harassment complaints** — under the POSH Act, 2013, dealt with by the Internal Committee (IC) and the SHe-Box portal (Chapter XIII).
- SC/ST employee grievances** — service-matter grievances of SC/ST employees, monitored through the NCSC/NCST (Chapter XIV).
- Complaints against high-level functionaries** — a distinct, protective procedure exists for complaints against Secretaries to the Government of India (Chapter XII).

Exam Focus

Learn the **competent authority** for each class: service deficiency → Postmaster/SP (administrative); corruption → Divisional Head/CVO (vigilance); harassment → IC; SC/ST service matter → NCSC/NCST route.

PART 2 — INSTITUTIONAL MECHANISMS & GENERAL PROCEDURE

IV. CPGRAMS — the GoI Grievance Backbone

CPGRAMS (Centralised Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System) is an online, 24×7 platform developed by NIC and administered by DARPG. It is a single window connected to all Ministries/Departments of the Centre and the States, accessible on the web (pgportal.gov.in), through a mobile app (also integrated with UMANG) and at Common

Service Centres. Grievances relating to the Department of Posts are auto-routed to the mapped DoP Grievance Redressal Officers (GROs) / nodal officers.

⚠ **Currency Alert — the timeline has changed**

The older notes quote a **30-day** window under the 27.07.2022 guidelines. This is **superseded**. By the **Comprehensive Guidelines for Handling Public Grievances, DARPG O.M. F.No. S-15/21/2021-(PG)-DARPG dated 23.08.2024**, the maximum redressal time in CPGRAMS is now **21 days**. Where more time is genuinely needed, an *interim reply* must be given with reasons and an expected date.

✓ **Salient features of the 2024 Guidelines**

- Maximum redressal time reduced from 30 to **21 days**; priority/critical grievances even faster.
- “Whole-of-government” approach — a grievance must **never** be closed as “does not pertain to this Ministry/Department/Office”; it must be transferred to the right authority.
- Dedicated **Grievance Cells** and a **nodal officer** of sufficient rank in high-volume Ministries.
- Feedback to the citizen by *SMS and e-mail*; a feedback call-centre survey; and an **appeal** option if the citizen rates the redress “Poor”.
- Technology & assessment — AI-enabled dashboards, root-cause analysis, and the **Grievance Redressal Assessment Index (GRAI)**.

Two further points worth knowing

Service matters of Government employees (disciplinary proceedings, etc.) are **not** ordinarily taken up on CPGRAMS unless the employee has exhausted the prescribed channels — *DoPT O.M. No. 11013/08/2013-Estt.(A-III) dated 31.08.2015*.

Secretary-level review: from January 2025 a framework for review of public grievances at the level of Secretaries to the Government of India was introduced, deepening monitoring above the nodal-officer tier.

V. India Post CRM — the Departmental System

The Customer Relationship Management (CRM) portal is the Department’s own IT platform for registering, tracking and resolving customer complaints at Post Office, Division and Circle levels. A citizen may lodge a complaint through several channels, all of which feed the CRM:

- **Online:** crm.indiapost.gov.in — register and track with the complaint number.
- **Telephone:** National Call Centre, toll-free 1800-266-6868 (working hours; IVRS 24×7).
- **Mobile:** the PostInfo app (complaint registration & status).

- **At the counter / in writing** at any Post Office, and via official social-media handles.

Exam Focus

CRM vs CPGRAMS: CRM is the internal DoP system; CPGRAMS is the overarching GoI portal run by DARPG. A grievance unresolved on CRM can be escalated to CPGRAMS and, ultimately, to the DPG (Cabinet Secretariat).

VI. Call Centre, Social Media & CCC

- **National Call Centre** — toll-free 1800-266-6868 for telephonic complaints, feeding the CRM.
- **Social media** — DoP actively monitors its official handles (e.g. @IndiaPostOffice) for immediate grievance capture and response.
- **Computerised Customer Care Centres (CCC)** — at Head Post Offices, to log and resolve physical and digital complaints.

Closure discipline for these channels

Grievances of *delay/loss of articles* received through the Call Centre, social media (Twitter/X) and CCC may be closed **only** after the final delivery status is verified or compensation is sanctioned — per DoP O.M. No. 14-03/2018-PG dated 25.06.2018 (as cited in departmental material).

VII. Designated Officers

- **Grievance Redressal Officers (GROs)** — the officers mapped on CPGRAMS who actually dispose of grievances; over one lakh GROs are mapped across Government.
- **Public Grievance Officers (PGOs)** — appointed at the Directorate, Circle and Regional levels to monitor disposal.
- **Nodal Officers** — coordinate timely resolution of CPGRAMS and CRM tickets; the 2024 guidelines cast on them the duties of effective categorisation, monitoring pendency, root-cause analysis, monthly data collation and supervisory oversight of GROs.

VIII. Step-by-Step Procedure for a Service Complaint

1. **Receipt & registration** — physical complaints are logged in CRM; digital complaints (CPGRAMS, e-mail, social media) are auto-routed or mapped to the concerned office; a unique registration number is generated and sent to the complainant by SMS/e-mail.
2. **Preliminary scrutiny** — the receiving officer checks jurisdiction; if it belongs elsewhere, it is transferred within CRM/CPGRAMS (never returned or closed as “not ours”). Missing basic details (article number, date of booking) are sought.

3. **Forwarding to the competent authority** — vigilance complaints go confidentially to the Divisional Head/CVO; operational complaints go to the concerned Postmaster or Mail Overseer for ground verification.
4. **Investigation & verification** — original records (delivery slips, beat books, system tracking logs) are checked; where financial loss or fraud is suspected, a preliminary enquiry is ordered at once.
5. **Action & resolution** — corrective action is taken (delayed article delivered, pending COD/Money Order paid); for loss or damage, compensation is sanctioned per the Post Office Guide rules.
6. **Communication & closure** — a reasoned, polite, descriptive reply is issued; generic one-line replies are barred; the ticket is marked “Closed” only after the resolution is communicated.

IX. Closure of Complaints

Closure is as important as registration — improper closure causes appeals and dissatisfaction and defeats the purpose of the mechanism.

- **Substantive resolution only:** a ticket may be closed only when a final, substantive resolution has been provided. Interim replies (“under investigation”) do not justify closure.
- **COD grievances:** a non-payment-of-COD grievance may be closed only after the amount is actually credited to the sender/biller — per *DoP O.M. No. 10-32/2013-BD&MD (Vol-II) dated 11.12.2015* (as cited).
- **Documentary backing:** every closure must be supported by evidence (delivery-slip signature, payment voucher).
- **Quality of reply:** “Matter resolved” is insufficient; the correct standard is, e.g., “Article delivered on DD/MM/YYYY vide beat no. X; customer satisfied.”

PART 3 — SPECIALISED COMPLAINT STREAMS

X. Anonymous & Pseudonymous Complaints

This is one of the most frequently tested areas, because the rule protects honest officers from frivolous, vindictive or blackmail-driven allegations.

Definitions

Anonymous complaint — does not carry the name and address of the complainant.

Pseudonymous complaint — carries a name/address that is fictitious, or one that cannot be verified after due procedure (e.g. the acknowledgment returns undelivered or the person denies sending it).

The core rule

✓ Current Position (Verified)

No action is to be taken on anonymous or pseudonymous complaints — they are simply **filed**. This is now consolidated in the **CVC Vigilance Manual, 2021 (Chapter III, Paras 3.12.1 & 3.12.3)**, and reiterated in the CVC's **Comprehensive Guidelines on Complaint Handling Mechanism, Circular No. 25/12/21 dated 24.12.2021 (Chapter V, Para 5.6.1)**. It rests on the older CVC circulars dated 29.06.1999 and 31.01.2002, reiterated by CVC Circular No. 07/03/16 dated 07.03.2016.

⚠ Correction to a common citation

Circulating notes cite this as “CVC OM 39-1/2010-Vig dated 29-03-2016”. The correct reference is the **Postal Directorate letter No. 36-1/2010-Vig dated 29.03.2016** (note 36, not 39), which communicated **CVC Circular No. 07/03/16 dated 07.03.2016**. The overarching, current authority is the CVC Vigilance Manual 2021 read with CVC Circular 25/12/21.

Verification procedure (where a name/address is given)

- A registered letter is issued to the complainant to confirm identity (with a copy of ID proof). If no reply is received within 15 days, a reminder is issued with a further 15 days. If still no reply, the complaint is treated as pseudonymous and filed.
- If a verifiable reply is received in time, the complaint is investigated further as per CVC guidelines.
- **Postal practice:** when a complaint is received, the genuineness is verified by deputing an **IP/ASP/PRI(P)** for a discreet check before any formal action.
- **Vague allegations** (e.g. “the Postmaster is corrupt”, with no dates, amounts or specifics) are filed without verification of identity — DoPT complaint-handling policy, O.M. No. 104/76/2011-AVD.I dated 18.10.2013.

⚠ Non-compliance is viewed seriously

CVC has warned that some organisations still act on anonymous complaints despite the ban; such non-compliance will be **viewed seriously** — CVC Circular No. 12/09/20 dated 24.09.2020.

XI. PIDPI – Whistle-blower Complaints

An anonymous complaint is filed with no action; but a genuine informer who wishes to hide his identity is protected through a different route – PIDPI.

What PIDPI is

PIDPI = Public Interest Disclosure and Protection of Informer. It flows from the Government of India Resolution No. 89 (the “PIDPI Resolution, 2004”) dated 21.04.2004, which designated the **Central Vigilance Commission (CVC)** as the agency to receive and act on written complaints of corruption or misuse of office while keeping the informer’s identity secret.

How a PIDPI complaint is made and handled

- The complaint is addressed to the CVC (or the CVO of the concerned Ministry). The envelope is superscribed “PIDPI” or “PUBLIC INTEREST DISCLOSURE & PROTECTION OF INFORMER”.
- The complainant’s name and full details go inside, in a closed cover — not on the envelope.
- It is opened only by a designated nodal officer; the identity is concealed and the matter is processed as a “source complaint” using a reference number, so the informer is not victimised.
- **Departmental application:** Circles have issued implementation instructions on strict non-disclosure of identity — e.g. *Punjab Circle O.M. No. CPT/20-1/2019 dated 26.03.2021* (an illustration of Circle-level rollout).

⚠ The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 is not yet in force

The **Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 (Act 17 of 2014)** was enacted but has **not been brought into force** (rules not notified). Until then, whistle-blower complaints in Government continue to be governed by the **PIDPI Resolution, 2004** administered by the CVC.

Exam Focus

Learn the **expansion of PIDPI**, that the **CVC** is the designated agency, the **envelope superscription**, and that the WBP Act 2014 is **not yet operational**.

XII. Vigilance-Related Complaints

Vigilance complaints allege a mala fide act — bribery, embezzlement of post-office cash, or intentional misuse of official position.

Service grievance vs vigilance complaint

- A service grievance (e.g. delay in delivery) is handled administratively. But if the delay is shown to be *deliberate* — *to extract a bribe* — it **converts** into a vigilance complaint.
- All vigilance complaints are routed to the **Divisional Head** or the **Circle Vigilance Officer (CVO)**, depending on the rank of the accused official.

First-stage and second-stage advice of the CVC

When the CVC is consulted

First-stage advice: sought after the preliminary enquiry/investigation report is ready — to decide whether to drop the matter or initiate minor/major penalty proceedings.

Second-stage advice: sought after the formal inquiry is complete but *before* the Disciplinary Authority imposes the final penalty — to ensure the penalty is commensurate with the proven misconduct. (Ref: CVC Circular No. 003/VGL/056 dated 28.01.2010, now read with the Vigilance Manual 2021.)

Complaints against high-ranking functionaries

- There is a distinct, protective procedure for complaints against **Secretaries to the Government of India** — DoPT (AVD) O.M. No. 104/100/2009-AVD.I dated 14.01.2010 (with corrigenda). Such complaints are not handled by ordinary disciplinary authorities; they are scrutinised by a high-level committee/Group of Ministers, and no agency investigation is initiated without that approval.

⚠ New criminal-procedure codes (context)

Preliminary enquiry is distinct from investigation of a criminal offence, which is conducted by CBI/police under the **Code of Criminal Procedure, 1973** — **now the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), 2023 (in force 01.07.2024)**; the substantive offences shifted from the IPC to the **Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), 2023**. Older vigilance material citing the CrPC/IPC should be read with this change.

XIII. Sexual-Harassment Complaints (POSH)

The Department maintains a zero-tolerance policy on workplace sexual harassment, under the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013 (“POSH Act”) and its 2013 Rules, read with DoPT/MWCD instructions.

⚠ Currency Alert — “ICC” is now “Internal Committee (IC)”

The committee that inquires into complaints was originally called the *Internal Complaints Committee (ICC)*. The **Repealing and Amending Act, 2016 (Act 23 of 2016), w.e.f. 09.05.2016**, substituted “Internal Complaints Committee” with “**Internal Committee (IC)**” throughout the Act (and “Local Complaints Committee” with “Local

Committee (LC)"). Write **Internal Committee (IC)** in the exam; ICC survives only as older usage.

Constitution of the Internal Committee — Section 4

- Every employer of a workplace with **10 or more employees** must, by written order, constitute an IC (in DoP: every Division and administrative office).
- **Presiding Officer** — a **senior woman** employee.
- **At least two members** from among employees committed to the cause of women or having experience in social work / legal knowledge.
- **One external member** from an NGO/association committed to the cause of women or a person familiar with issues of sexual harassment.
- At least **half the members must be women**; term up to **three years**. The IC has the powers of a civil court and must complete inquiry, as far as possible, within **90 days**.

Seniority of the Presiding Officer

The Presiding Officer must be a senior woman employee; if one of sufficient seniority is not available in the same office, she may be nominated from another office/unit so that she is **not junior to the accused**, preventing undue influence — DoPT O.M. No. 11013/2/2014-Estt.A-III (09.09.2016 & 07.11.2016).

The IC report and follow-up

- For a government servant, the IC's report is treated as the **inquiry report** for the purposes of the CCS (CCA) Rules, 1965 — the Disciplinary Authority acts on it without a fresh parallel inquiry (DoPT O.M. No. 11013/3/2009-Estt.(A) dated 02.02.2009 & 08.10.2009). Strict follow-up on the report is mandatory.

SHe-Box portal

▲ Currency Alert — the SHe-Box was relaunched in 2024

The original SHe-Box (2017) routed a complaint to the MWCD, which forwarded it to the concerned ICC. A **new SHe-Box was relaunched on 29.08.2024** at **shebox.wcd.gov.in**. It is a central repository of every IC and LC in the country and lets a complainant submit the complaint **directly to the concerned IC/LC**, and track its time-bound processing. (The 2017 launch order was DoPT O.M. No. 11013/7/2016-Estt.A-III dated 11.01.2017.)

Supreme Court push on POSH compliance

Following *Aureliano Fernandes v. State of Goa* (2023), the Supreme Court, by orders dated **03.12.2024, 12.08.2025 and 06.01.2026**, directed States/UTs to survey whether

public and private organisations have constituted ICs under Section 4 and to activate/integrate the SHe-Box — raising the compliance bar for every Government office, including Post Offices.

Exam Focus

Displaying the **names & contacts of IC members** prominently in the Post Office is mandatory. Remember: **IC (not ICC); senior woman Presiding Officer; external member compulsory; SHe-Box → shebox.wcd.gov.in (2024); inquiry within 90 days.**

XIV. Grievances of SC/ST Employees

Service-matter grievances of Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe employees (promotion, transfer, alleged discriminatory treatment) are monitored with high priority.

△ Currency Alert — the “Commissioner for SC/ST” no longer exists

The old DoPT O.M.s (1970–1983) refer to a single *Commissioner for SC/ST*. That office was replaced: the 65th Amendment (1990) created a multi-member National Commission for SCs & STs, and the **Constitution (89th Amendment) Act, 2003 (w.e.f. 19.02.2004) bifurcated it into two Commissions** — the **National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC) under Article 338** and the **National Commission for Scheduled Tribes (NCST) under Article 338A**. Write NCSC/NCST, not “Commissioner”, for the current position.

The surviving principles (from the old OMs, still good law in substance)

- Ministries/Departments must give **full assistance** to the Commission investigating a complaint, and provide facts/figures/records promptly (O.M. 16/8/68-Estt dated 24.04.1970).
- The Commission can **call for original records and files**; and an SC/ST employee may write **directly** to the Commission where local suppression is feared (O.M. 8/2/69-(SCT)(1) dated 01.10.1974).
- Departments must send an **Action Taken Report (ATR)** — references cannot merely be filed away (O.M. 36034/2/83-Estt(SCT) dated 23.02.1983).

✓ Current channel

These functions are today discharged by the NCSC and NCST. The NCSC operates an online **e-Grievance Management Portal (e-GMP)** (ncscmis.nic.in) for receiving and monitoring grievances. Both Commissions have the powers of a civil court while inquiring, and their reports go to the President and Parliament; recommendations are advisory.

PART 4 – TIMELINES, MONITORING & RESPONSIBILITIES

XV. Timelines for Disposal

Channel / matter	Governing framework	Timeline
CPGRAMS (GoI)	DARPG Guidelines dated 23.08.2024	Ordinarily 21 days
CPGRAMS – longer cases	Same	Interim reply with reasons + expected date
Service matters of employees	DoPT O.M. 31.08.2015	Only after prescribed channels exhausted
India Post CRM (internal)	DoP PG SOP (04.09.2023) / timeline order (18.08.2022), as cited	Tighter internal targets by category
POSH – IC inquiry	POSH Act, 2013, s.11/13	As far as possible within 90 days

△ What to write on “the timeline”

The single most important figure is now **21 days for CPGRAMS** (from 30 days). The Department’s internal CRM targets are often shorter for its own SLAs, but the **Government-wide, verifiable ceiling is 21 days**.

XVI. Monitoring & Review

- **Dashboards:** Directorate and Circle Offices use dynamic, AI-enabled dashboards; a grievance breaching the timeline is red-flagged.
- **Root-cause analysis & GRAI:** the 2024 guidelines require RCA and rank Ministries/Departments on the **Grievance Redressal Assessment Index (GRAI)**.
- **Periodic review:** public-grievance handling is reviewed in monthly coordination meetings by the Head of Circle (CPMG) / Divisional Superintendent; from **January 2025**, a review framework at the level of **Secretaries to the GoI** operates above this. Persistent delay can invite administrative action against the responsible supervisory staff.

XVII. Responsibilities by Level

Level	Primary grievance role
Postmaster (HO/SO)	First point of contact: log physical/oral complaints in CRM; fact-finding on delayed mail, missing articles, counter-staff behaviour; de-escalate with customers.
Divisional Supt. (SP/SSP)	Nodal authority for all CRM/CPGRAMS tickets of the division; initiate preliminary enquiry into vigilance complaints and take minor/major penalty action for intentional lapses or gross negligence; weekly review for zero pendency.

Level	Primary grievance role
Circle Office (CPMG/DPS)	Appellate review of closed grievances; analyse grievance data to fix systemic failures (e.g. chronic route delays).
Postal Directorate	Policy, SOPs and timelines; inter-ministerial coordination with DARPG, CVC, MWCD and DPG.

XVIII. Practical Implementation Tips

- 1. Immediate acknowledgment** — whether the complaint is at the counter or on social media, prompt acknowledgment defuses tension.
- 2. Root-cause analysis** — don't just deliver the delayed parcel; find *why* it was delayed (missent by RMS, kept pending by the postman) and fix that node.
- 3. Proper CRM remarks** — enter detailed, date-wise remarks; "Matter resolved" is barred.
- 4. IC awareness** — display the IC members' names and contacts prominently; register the IC on SHe-Box.
- 5. Capacity building** — a dedicated course, "Grievance Handling Mechanism in India Post", is available on the Dak Karmayogi (iGOT) platform for staff training.

PART 5 — DIGEST OF IMPORTANT ORDERS

XIX. Chronological Table of Key Orders

Updated and corrected. Government-of-India framework orders are verified against primary/authoritative sources; DoP-internal PG-Division OMs are shown as cited in departmental study material (see Part 7 for the verification status of each).

Year	Authority	Order / Reference	Subject / key point
1970	DoPT	16/8/68-Estt (24.04.1970)	Ministries to assist the Commission investigating SC/ST complaints.
1974	DoPT	8/2/69-(SCT)(1) (01.10.1974)	Commission may call for original records; SC/ST employee may write directly.
1983	DoPT	36034/2/83-Estt(SCT) (23.02.1983)	Action-Taken Report on SC/ST complaints; references not to be merely filed.
2004	GoI/CVC	PIDPI Resolution No. 89 (21.04.2004)	Whistle-blower protection; CVC designated agency.
2004	Constitution	89th Amendment (w.e.f. 19.02.2004)	NCSC (Art. 338) & NCST (Art. 338A) replace the Commissioner.
2009	DoPT	11013/3/2009-Estt.(A) (02.02 & 08.10.2009)	IC report treated as inquiry report; Secretary-level committee.

Year	Authority	Order / Reference	Subject / key point
2010	DoPT (AVD)	104/100/2009-AVD.I (14.01.2010)	Protective procedure for complaints against Secretaries to GoI.
2010	CVC	003/VGL/056 (28.01.2010)	First-stage / second-stage advice of the CVC.
2013	DoPT (AVD)	104/76/2011-AVD.I (18.10.2013)	Base complaint-handling policy; vague/anonymous complaints filed.
2015	DoP	10-32/2013-BD&MD (11.12.2015)	COD grievance closed only after amount credited.
2015	DoPT	11013/08/2013-Estt.(A-III) (31.08.2015)	CPGRAMS not for employee service matters unless channels exhausted.
2016	Parliament	Repealing & Amending Act, 2016 (09.05.2016)	ICC → Internal Committee (IC); LCC → Local Committee (LC).
2016	CVC / DoP	Cir. 07/03/16 (07.03.2016); Dte 36-1/2010-Vig (29.03.2016)	No action on anonymous/pseudonymous complaints (reiterated).
2016	DoPT	11013/2/2014-Estt.A-III (09.09 & 07.11.2016)	Seniority of the Presiding Officer of the IC.
2017	DoPT/MWCD	11013/7/2016-Estt.A-III (11.01.2017)	Original SHe-Box (2017) launched.
2018	DoP	14-03/2018-PG (25.06.2018)	Closure discipline for Call Centre / social media / CCC (loss/delay).
2020	CVC	12/09/20 (24.09.2020)	Acting on anonymous complaints — non-compliance viewed seriously.
2021	CVC	Vigilance Manual 2021; Cir. 25/12/21 (24.12.2021)	Consolidated complaint-handling & anonymous-complaint framework.
2021	DoP (Circle)	CPT/20-1/2019 (26.03.2021)	PIDPI identity non-disclosure — Circle-level implementation.
2022	DoP	PG-01/3/2021-PG-DoP (18.08.2022)	Reduction of CRM disposal timelines (as cited).
2023	DoP	009/5/2023-PG (04.09.2023)	SOP for complaint handling on India Post CRM (as cited).
2024	DARPG	S-15/21/2021-(PG)-DARPG (23.08.2024)	CPGRAMS redressal timeline reduced 30 → 21 days.
2024	MWCD	New SHe-Box launched (29.08.2024)	shebox.wcd.gov.in — direct routing to IC/LC.
2025	DARPG	Secretary-level PG review framework (Jan 2025)	Review of public grievances at Secretary level.

PART 6 — EXAM CORNER

XX. High-Yield Points to Revise

- **Anonymous/pseudonymous rule:** no action — file it. Current authority: CVC Vigilance Manual 2021 + Circular 25/12/21 (24.12.2021).
- **PIDPI:** Public Interest Disclosure and Protection of Informer; CVC is the designated agency; envelope superscribed “PIDPI”; WBP Act 2014 not yet in force.
- **POSH:** Internal Committee (IC), senior-woman Presiding Officer, external member compulsory, ≥50% women, 90-day inquiry; SHe-Box at shebox.wcd.gov.in (relaunched 2024).
- **CRM vs CPGRAMS vs DPG:** CRM = DoP internal; CPGRAMS = DARPG (GoI, 21-day timeline since 23.08.2024); DPG = Cabinet Secretariat apex appeal.
- **SC/ST:** NCSC (Art. 338) & NCST (Art. 338A) since 2004; NCSC e-GMP portal; Commissions can call for original records.
- **Vigilance advice:** first stage after PE report; second stage after inquiry, before penalty.

XXI. Practice MCQs

1. The maximum time now advised by DARPG for redressal of a grievance on CPGRAMS is:

- (a) 60 days
- (b) 45 days
- (c) 30 days
- (d) 21 days

Answer: (d) 21 days — DARPG Guidelines dated 23.08.2024.

2. Under the POSH Act (as amended in 2016), the inquiring body is now correctly called the:

- (a) Internal Complaints Committee (ICC)
- (b) Internal Committee (IC)
- (c) Grievance Redressal Committee
- (d) Vishaka Committee

Answer: (b) Internal Committee (IC) — renamed by the Repealing & Amending Act, 2016.

3. Action to be taken on a purely anonymous complaint (no name/address) is to:

- (a) Order a preliminary enquiry
- (b) Refer it to CBI
- (c) File it — no action
- (d) Send it to CPGRAMS

Answer: (c) File it — CVC Vigilance Manual 2021 / Circular 25/12/21.

4. "PIDPI" stands for:

- (a) Public Information Disclosure & Privacy Institute
- (b) Public Interest Disclosure and Protection of Informer
- (c) Postal Internal Data Protection Instruction
- (d) Public Integrity & Departmental Probity Initiative

Answer: (b) Public Interest Disclosure and Protection of Informer.

5. The relaunched SHe-Box portal (2024) is hosted at:

- (a) pgportal.gov.in
- (b) shebox.wcd.gov.in
- (c) crm.indiapost.gov.in
- (d) dpq.gov.in

Answer: (b) shebox.wcd.gov.in — relaunched 29.08.2024 by MWCD.

6. Grievances of SC citizens/employees to the Commission are now handled by:

- (a) The Commissioner for SC/ST
- (b) The National Commission for Scheduled Castes (Art. 338)
- (c) The Directorate of Public Grievances
- (d) The CVC

Answer: (b) NCSC under Article 338 (with NCST under Article 338A).

7. Second-stage advice of the CVC is sought:

- (a) Before the preliminary enquiry
- (b) After inquiry, before the Disciplinary Authority imposes penalty
- (c) After the penalty is imposed
- (d) Only for anonymous complaints

Answer: (b) After the formal inquiry and before imposition of the final penalty.

8. A COD-related grievance may be closed on CRM only after:

- (a) An interim reply is sent
- (b) 30 days elapse
- (c) The COD amount is actually credited to the sender/biller
- (d) The article is booked

Answer: (c) The amount is actually credited — DoP O.M. dated 11.12.2015.

PART 7 – VERIFICATION & CURRENCY RECORD

XXII. How These Notes Were Checked

In keeping with the Dak Guru standard of primary-source accuracy, each major statement was checked against the governing order. The table below separates what is verified against authoritative/primary sources from what is retained as cited in departmental study material but could not be independently traced online.

✓ Verified against primary / authoritative sources

Point	Source relied on
CPGRAMS timeline now 21 days	DARPG O.M. F.No. S-15/21/2021-(PG)-DARPG dated 23.08.2024 (pgportal.gov.in).
Anonymous/pseudonymous – no action	CVC Vigilance Manual 2021 (Paras 3.12.1 & 3.12.3); CVC Cir. 25/12/21 (24.12.2021); Cir. 12/09/20; Cir. 07/03/16 via Dte Lr 36-1/2010-Vig (29.03.2016).
POSH: ICC → IC; LCC → LC	Repealing & Amending Act, 2016 (Act 23 of 2016), assent 09.05.2016; POSH Act, 2013, s.4.
SHe-Box relaunched 2024	MWCD / PIB press release, 29.08.2024; shebox.wcd.gov.in.
SC directions on POSH/IC surveys	Aureliano Fernandes v. State of Goa; SC orders 03.12.2024, 12.08.2025, 06.01.2026.
NCSC / NCST replace Commissioner	Constitution (89th Amendment) Act, 2003, w.e.f. 19.02.2004; Articles 338 & 338A; NCSC e-GMP (ncscmis.nic.in).
CrPC → BNSS; IPC → BNS	BNSS & BNS, 2023, in force 01.07.2024.
CRM live; DPG escalation	India Post grievance pages (indiapost.gov.in); crm.indiapost.gov.in; dpg.gov.in.

○ Retained as cited in departmental study material (not independently traced online)

The following DoP PG-Division OM numbers appear in circulating notes and are retained for exam continuity, but were not independently verifiable from a primary gazette/portal source. Treat the substance as correct and the numbers as “as cited”; verify from the original OM before official use:

- DoP O.M. No. 10-32/2013-BD&MD (Vol-II) dated 11.12.2015 (COD).
- DoP O.M. No. 14-03/2018-PG dated 25.06.2018 (closure via Call Centre/social media/CCC).
- DoP O.M. No. PG-01/3/2021-PG-DoP dated 18.08.2022 (CRM timeline reduction).
- DoP O.M. No. PG-29/1/2022-PG-DoP dated 28.07.2022 (PG review).
- DoP O.M. No. 009/5/2023-PG dated 04.09.2023 (CRM SOP).
- Punjab Circle O.M. No. CPT/20-1/2019 dated 26.03.2021 (PIDPI – Circle-level illustration).

Bottom line

For the examination, anchor your answers on the **verified GoI framework** — the 21-day CPGRAMS timeline, the CVC Vigilance Manual 2021, the Internal Committee (IC) and the 2024 SHe-Box, and the NCSC/NCST. These are current as on **August 2026**. Always confirm the latest position before relying on any point for official work.

